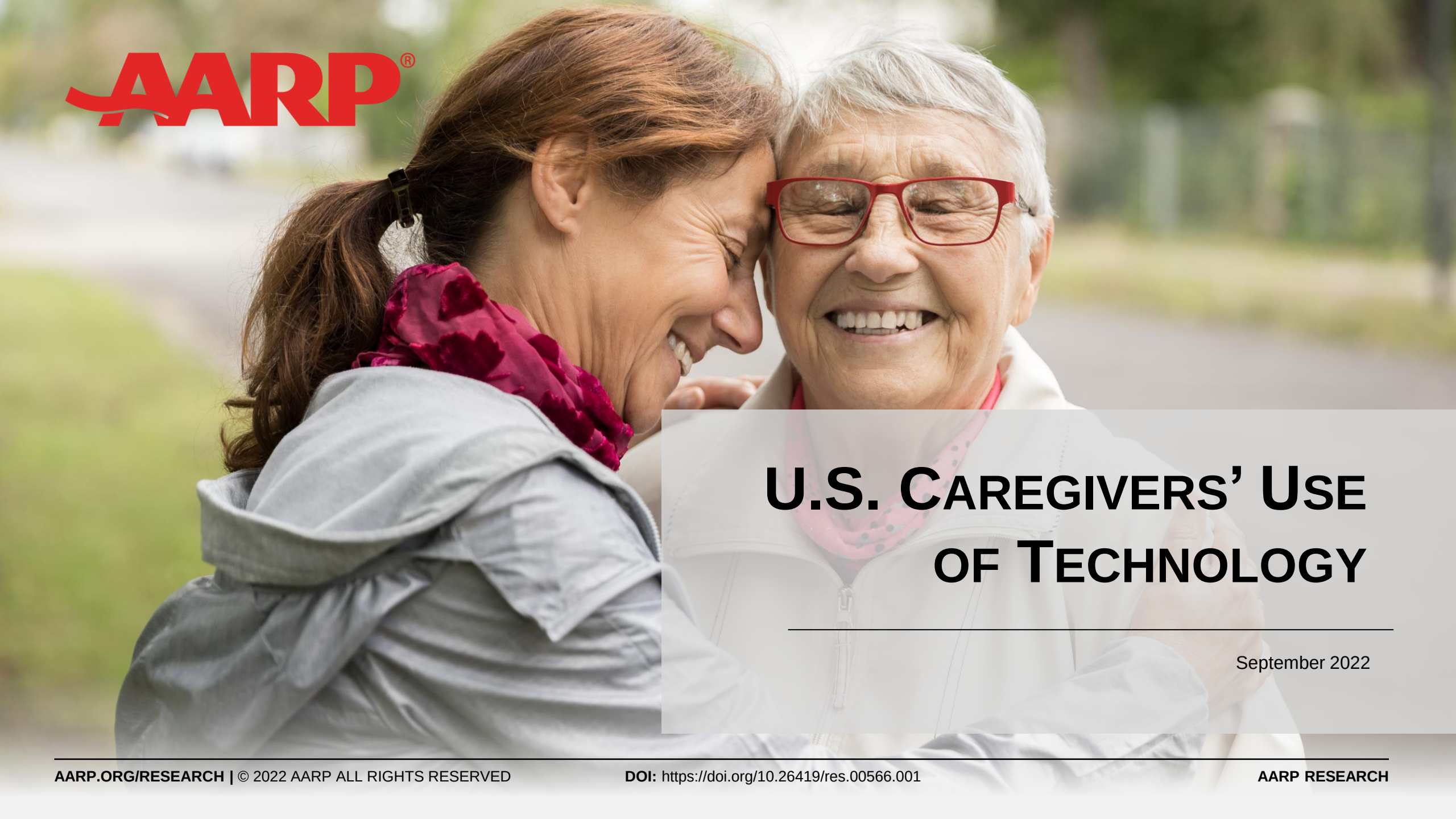


# U.S. Caregivers' Use of Technology

September 2022

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# KEY FINDINGS

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# Key findings

**The COVID-19 pandemic had a negative impact on caregivers**: Half said the pandemic made caregiving harder, with younger caregivers more likely to say so.

**The overall comfort level with technology is high among caregivers, albeit with differences across age groups.** Across all four technologies about which they were asked, caregivers younger than age 50 are more likely than their older counterparts to say they are *extremely* or *very comfortable* with them. Additionally, caregivers between the ages of 50 and 64 are more likely than those age 65 or older to note similar high comfort levels with the technologies.

While **most caregivers are comfortable with technology**, they are **mixed on the use of technology to assist with their caregiving duties**. While eight in ten caregivers 18-plus use technology to assist with caregiving at least once per month, many caregivers 50-plus said they *never* use technology in their caregiving role.

- Caregivers use their phones and Internet to search for support services, food deliveries, and prescription refills, among other items, and use technology and software for making home modifications and keeping track of health and financial records.

Notably, **three-quarters of caregivers 18-plus are *at least somewhat interested* in using technology** to assist with caregiving, with two-thirds of those under age 50 saying they are *extremely* or *very interested* in doing so.

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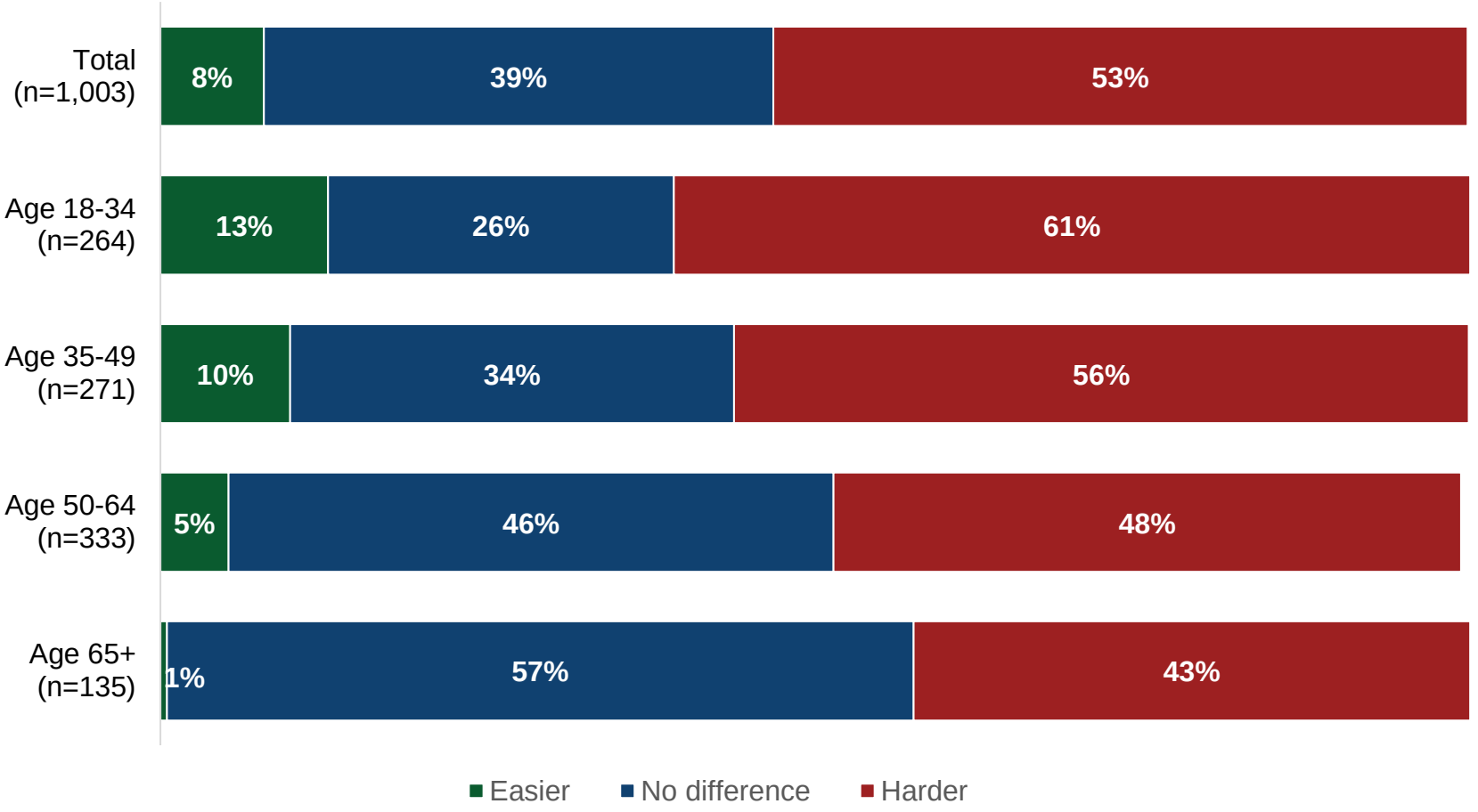


# USING TECHNOLOGY FOR CAREGIVING

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# The pandemic made caregiving harder

Half of caregivers say the COVID-19 pandemic made providing care harder, with younger caregivers more likely to say so.

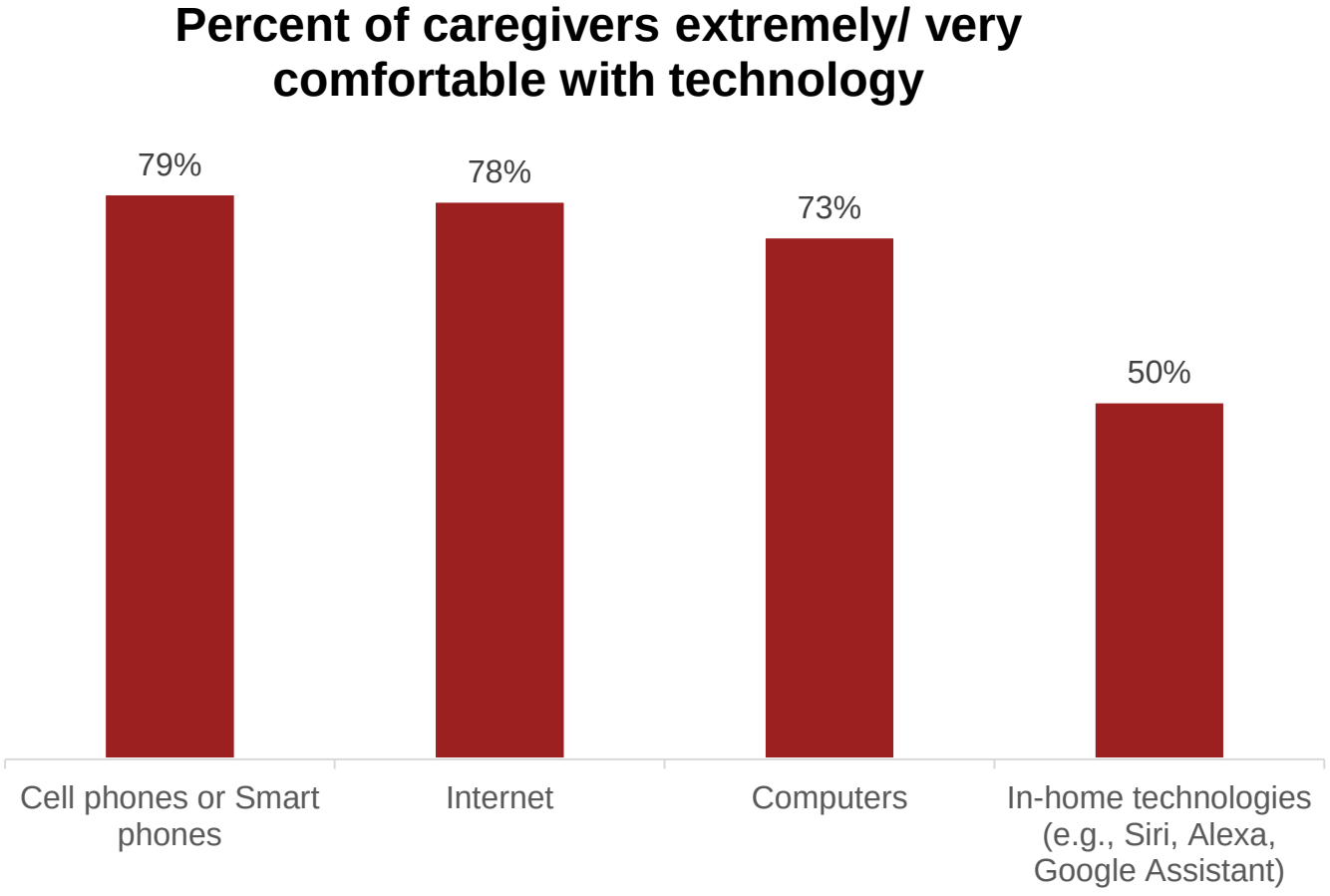





*Q1. How has the COVID-19 pandemic affected your ability to provide care to your relative or friend? Has the pandemic made it easier, harder, or has there been no difference? Base: All respondents (n=1,003)*

# Overall comfort level with technology is high among caregivers

Most caregivers said they feel comfortable using cell phones or smart phones, the Internet, and computers, with fewer noting comfort with in-home technologies, such as Siri, Alexa, or Google Assistant.






*Q10. In general, how comfortable are you using…? Base: All respondents (n=1,003)*

# While comfort levels are generally high among caregivers, younger caregivers are far more comfortable with technologies than their oldest counterparts

**Comfort with Using Various Technologies**
**by Age Group**
**(Percent 'Extremely or Very Comfortable')**

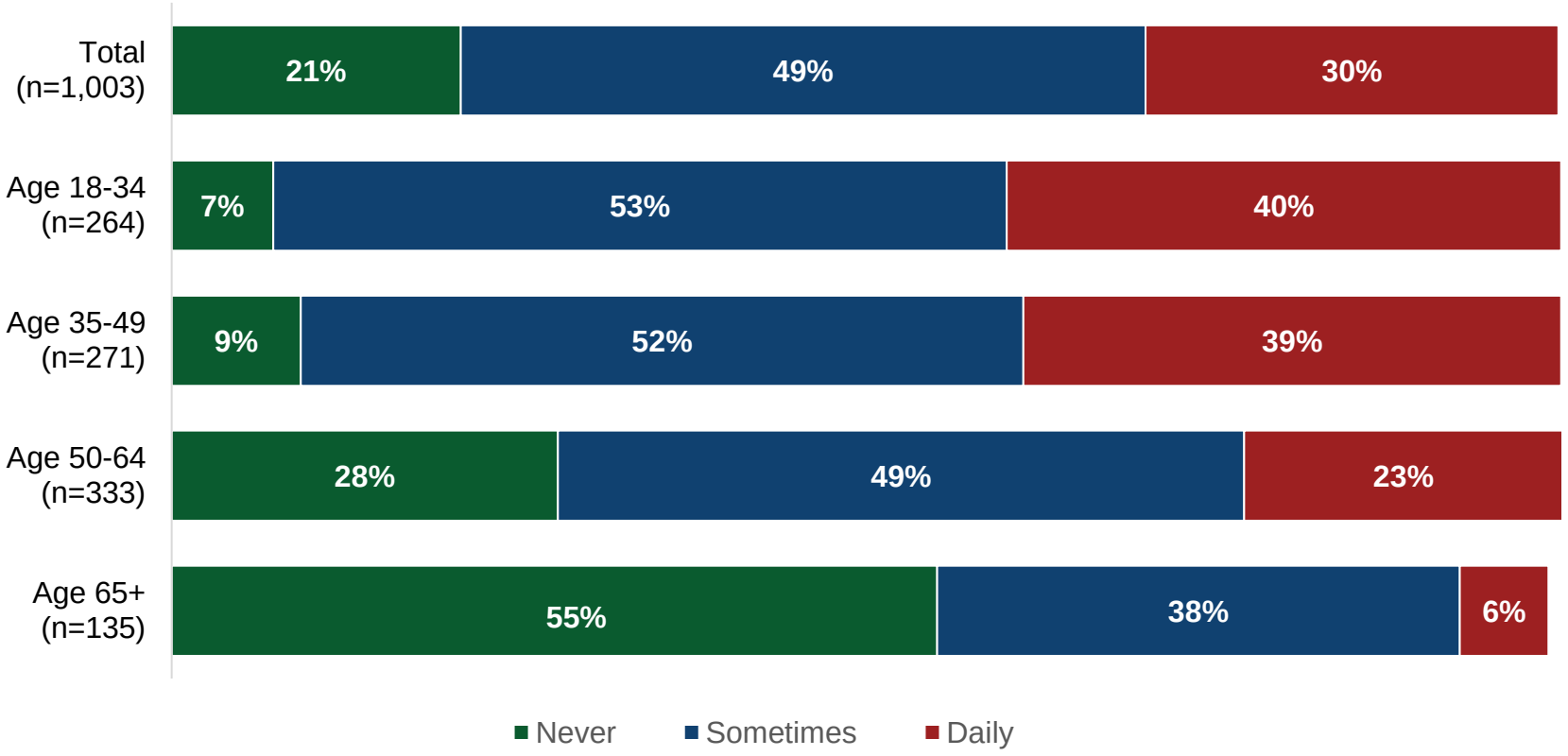
| *By Age Group* | **Total** | **18-34** | **35-49** | **50-64** | **65-plus** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | *n=1,003* | *n=266* | *n=294* | *n=302* | *n=142* |
| Cell phones or smart phones | 79% | 88% | 90% | 78% | 45% |
| Internet | 78% | 88% | 86% | 78% | 43% |
| Computers | 73% | 82% | 84% | 70% | 43% |
| In-home technologies (e.g., Siri, Alexa, Google Assistant) | 50% | 61% | 66% | 37% | 19% |

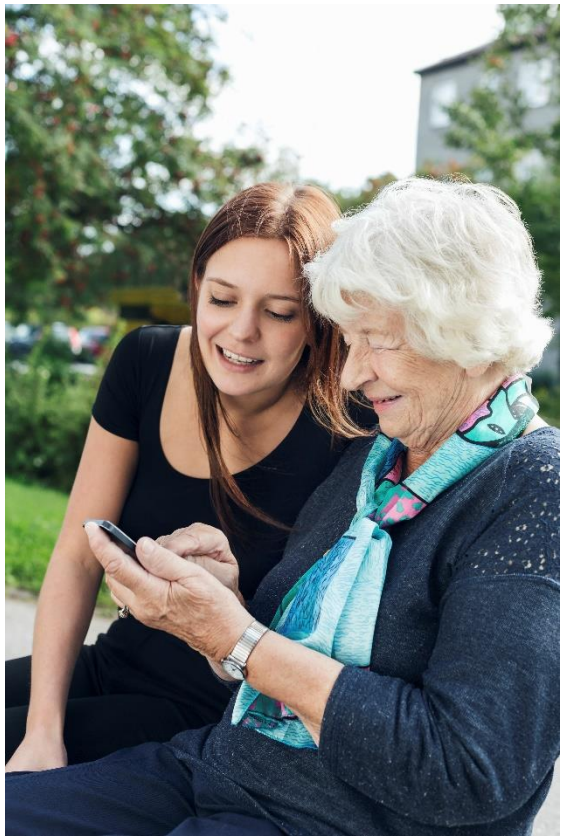
*Q10. In general, how comfortable are you using…? Base: All respondents (n=1,003)*

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# Caregivers vary in their use of technology for caregiving assistance

While eight in ten caregivers 18-plus use technology to assist with caregiving at least once per month, many caregivers 50-plus said they “never” use technology in their caregiving role.



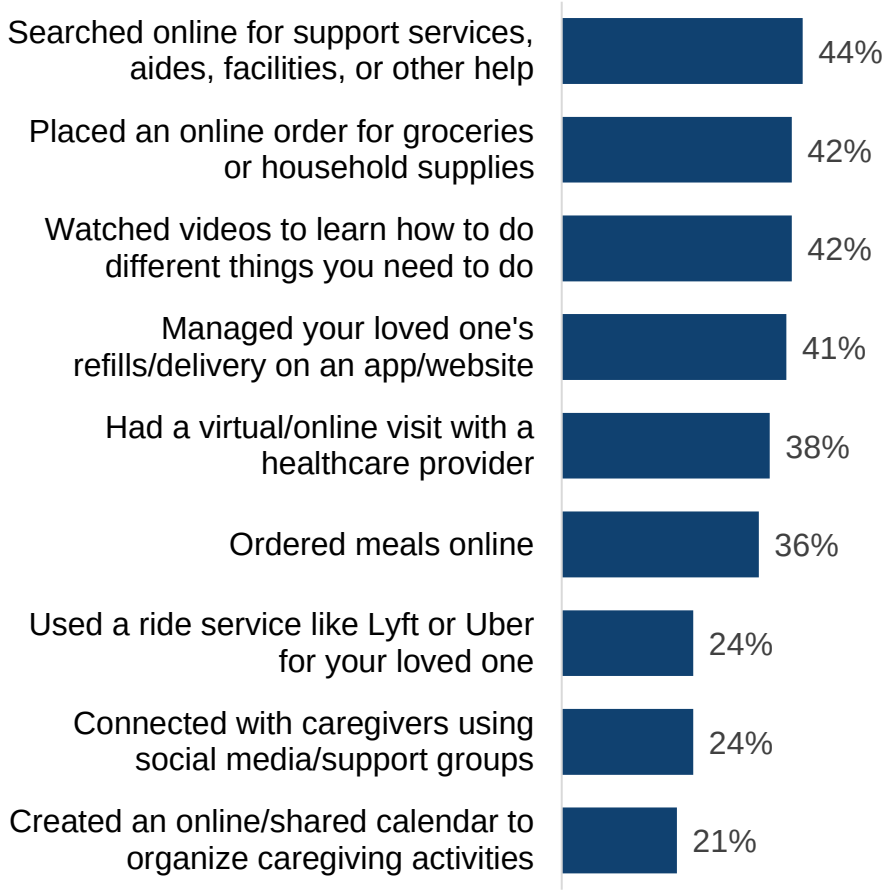



*Q11. How often do you use technology to assist with your caregiving responsibilities?*

*Base: All respondents (n=1,003)*

# Caregivers use their phones and Internet to search for support services, food deliveries, and prescription refills, among other items

## Activities done online or on a phone



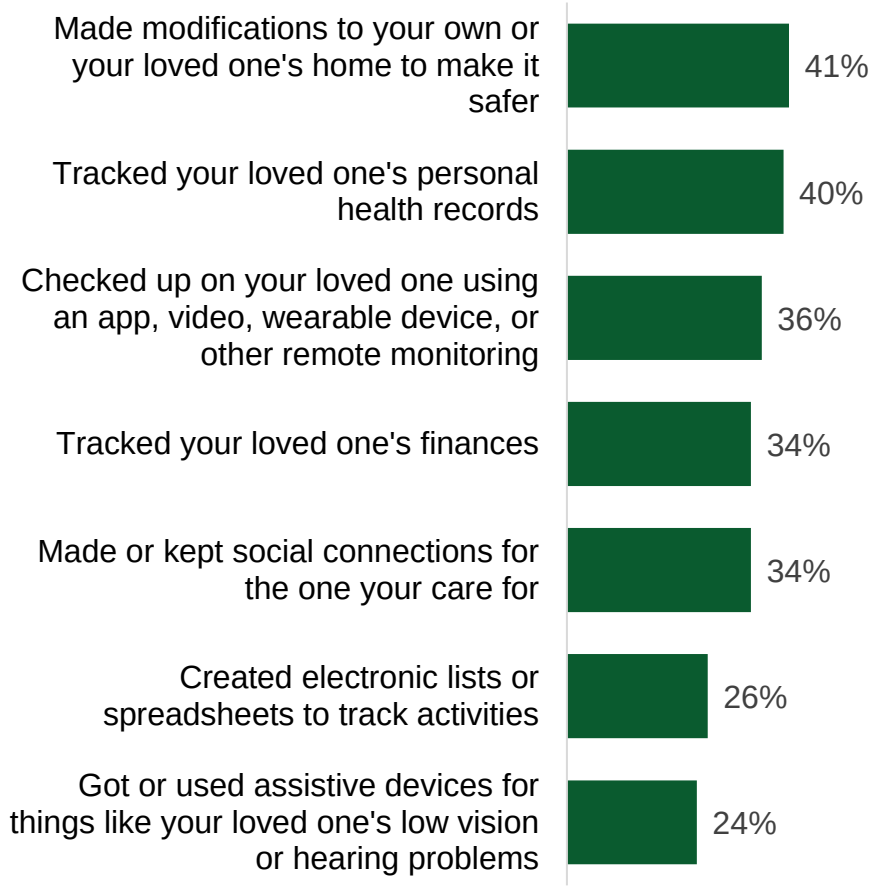



*Q13. In your experience as a caregiver, which of the following have you ever done online or on your phone? Select all that apply. Base: All respondents (n=1,003)*

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# And use technology and software for making home modifications and keeping track of health and financial records

## Activities done using technology



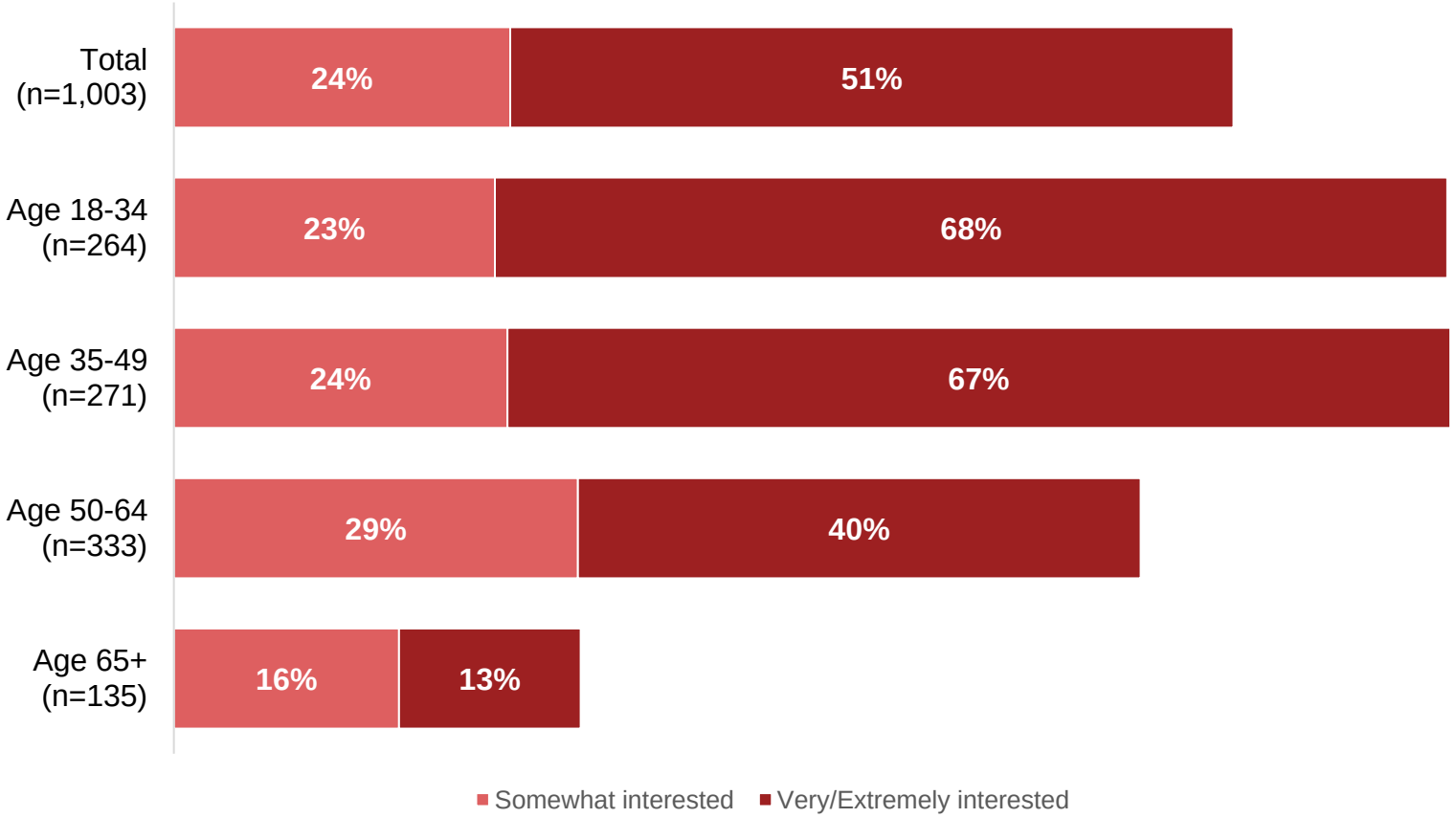



*Q14. In your experience as a caregiver, which of the following have you ever done using technology or software? Select all that apply. Base: All respondents (n=1,003)*

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# Many say they are interested in using technology for caregiving

Two-thirds of caregivers under age 50 are extremely or very interested in using technology for caregiving.






*Q12. How interested would you be in using technology to assist with your caregiving responsibilities? Base: All respondents (n=1,003)*



# IMPLICATIONS

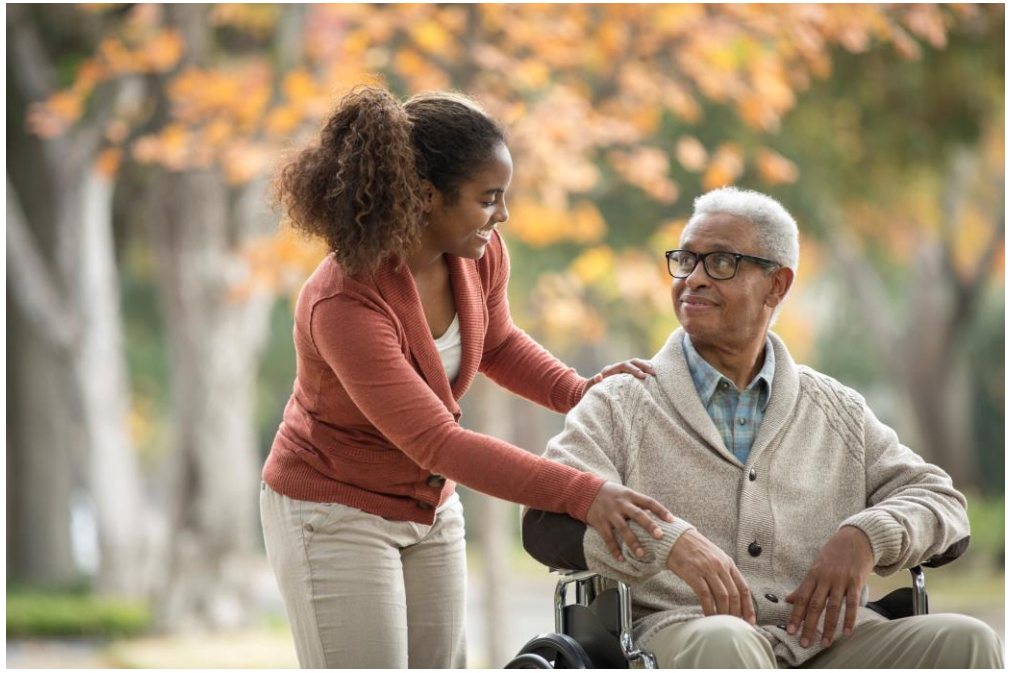
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# Implications

Our results show that family caregivers are receptive to and interested in using new and innovative technologies to help ease the challenges of caregiving.

The continued development and refinement of assistive technologies such as personal alarms, smart home monitoring systems, and even GPS trackers can help to enhance the independence and autonomy of individuals who are receiving care while also managing the safety and security issues which are often top-of-mind among family caregivers.

It is nonetheless important in this environment of caregiver receptivity and technological innovation that we do not lose sight of ethical concerns around data privacy and security; issues related to access, equity, and inclusion; and the incorporation of inclusive, human-centered design criteria into the development process.



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# DEMOGRAPHICS

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# Caregivers 18-Plus: A demographic overview

| | |
|---|---|
| Gender | |
| Male | 43% |
| Female | 56% |
| Age: | |
| 18-34 | 27% |
| 35-49 | 29% |
| 50-64 | 30% |
| 65+ | 14% |
| Race/Ethnicity (multi-select): | |
| White | 80% |
| Hispanic/Latino | 19% |
| Black/African American | 13% |
| Education: | |
| Some college or less | 66% |
| Bachelor’s degree or higher | 34% |
| AARP member: | |
| Yes | 19% |
| No | 73% |
| Veteran: | |
| Yes | 12% |
| No | 87% |
| Household income: | |
| <$30,000 | 28% |
| $30,000-$49,999 | 23% |
| $50,000-$74,999 | 18% |
| $75,000+ | 26% |
| Employment: | |
| Employed or self-employed full- or part-time | 60% |
| Retired | 19% |
| Unemployed or not in the labor force | 20% |
| Marital status: | |
| Married or living with a partner | 62% |
| Single and never married | 19% |
| Divorced or separated | 13% |
| Widowed | 5% |

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# METHODOLOGY

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# Methodology

- **Objectives**: To better understand the ways in which current and recent caregivers use technologies to help them in their caregiving role.
- **Methodology**: Landline, cell phone, and online sampling with telephone sample from a list of U.S. adults age 18+, purchased from Aristotle; online sample provided by Fulcrum
- **Qualifications**: Age 18 or older and currently providing unpaid care for an adult loved one or had provided care in the last three years
- **Sample**: n=1,003
- **Interviewing Dates**: March 31 to April 18, 2022; additional surveys were completed May 5 to May 12, 2022
- **Weighting**: The data are weighted by age, gender, race/ethnicity, education, and Census division according to Census Bureau 2020 5-year ACS statistics
- **Questionnaire length**: 14 minutes by telephone and 7 minutes online
- **Confidence Interval**: Total sample: ± 3.1%



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# About AARP

AARP is the nation’s largest nonprofit, nonpartisan organization dedicated to empowering Americans 50 and older to choose how they live as they age. With nearly 38 million members and offices in every state, the District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, and the U.S. Virgin Islands, AARP works to strengthen communities and advocate for what matters most to families with a focus on health security, financial stability and personal fulfillment. AARP also works for individuals in the marketplace by sparking new solutions and allowing carefully chosen, high-quality products and services to carry the AARP name. As a trusted source for news and information, AARP produces the nation's largest circulation publications, AARP The Magazine and AARP Bulletin. To learn more, visit www.aarp.org or follow @AARP and @AARPadvocates on social media.

# About ANR Market Research Consultants

ANR is a full-service market research firm founded in 1978. It has a full-time staff of twelve people and a part-time staff of thirty-five. As a Virginia SWaM-certified small business, ANR is managed by executives age 50-plus and also employs multiple professional staff age 50-plus. Its corporate offices, located in Richmond, Virginia, include a state-of-the-art focus group facility. ANR specializes in business and consumer research to determine attitudes and opinions, advertising effectiveness, organization image and awareness, market positioning and new product development. Its clients span a variety of industries, including state and federal government, health care, communications, finance, manufacturing, retail, travel, tourism, real estate development, and education. For more information, visit www.anr.com.

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